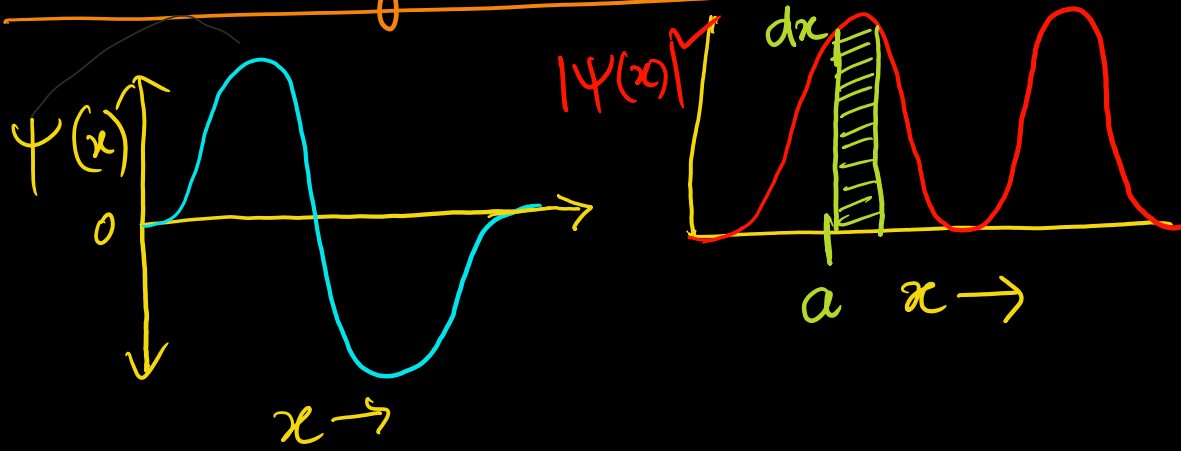


Interpreting the wavefunction



$\psi(x) \rightarrow$ Wave function

magnitude

$$|\psi(x)|^2 = \psi^*(x) \psi(x) \rightarrow \text{Probability Density}$$

Complex conjugate of ψ

$\psi(x) \in \mathbb{C}$ in general Complex number

$$\psi(x) = \text{Re}(x) + i \text{Im}(x)$$

$$\psi^*(x) = \text{Re}(x) - i \text{Im}(x)$$

$$c = a + bi$$

real imaginary

$$i = \sqrt{-1}$$

$$c^* = a - bi$$

$$|c|^2 = c^* c$$

"Born Interpretation"

$$\psi^*(x) \psi(x) dx = \text{Probability}$$

that the particle is
located between
 x and $x + dx$

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \psi^*(x) \psi(x) dx = 1$$

"Normalization"

Wave function must be
normalized

Particle in a Box

Free Particle,

$$V(x) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } 0 < x < l \\ \infty & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

$$\hat{H}\psi(x) = E\psi(x)$$

$$-\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{d^2\psi(x)}{dx^2} + \cancel{V(x)}\psi(x) = E\psi(x)$$

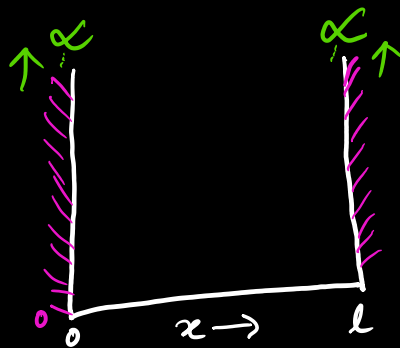
$$\frac{d^2\psi(x)}{dx^2} = -\frac{2m}{\hbar^2} E\psi(x)$$

$$\psi(x) = A \cos(kx) + B \sin(kx)$$

where $k = \frac{\sqrt{2mE}}{\hbar}$

$$\psi(x \leq 0) = 0 \rightarrow \psi(0) = 0$$

$$\psi(x > l) = 0 \rightarrow \psi(l) = 0$$



$V = 0$ in box and wall

$V = \infty$ outside

$$\psi(0) = A \cos(k \cdot 0) + B \sin(k \cdot 0) = A \rightarrow A = 0$$
$$\psi(l) = B \sin(kl) = 0 \quad kl = \sin^{-1}(0)$$

$$k = \frac{n\pi}{l} \quad n \in \mathbb{Z} \quad = n\pi$$

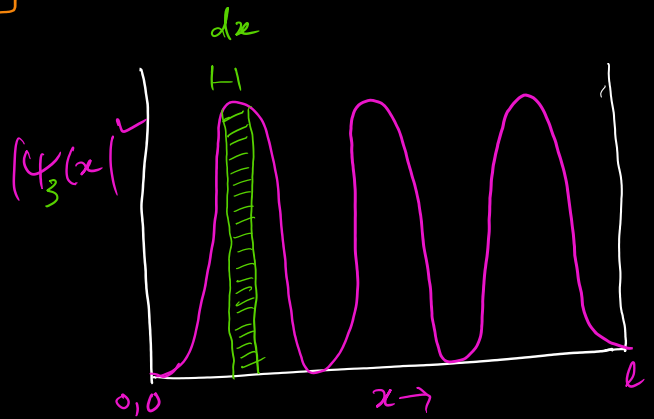
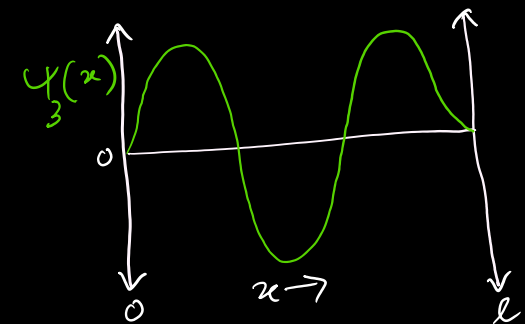
$$\psi_n(x) = B \sin\left(\frac{n\pi x}{l}\right) \quad n = 1, 2, 3, \dots$$

$$\frac{n\pi}{l} = \frac{\sqrt{2mE}}{\hbar} \quad \frac{n^2 \hbar^2 \pi^2}{l^2} = 2mE$$

$$E_n = \frac{\hbar^2 n^2}{8ml^2} \quad n = 1, 2, 3, \dots$$

$n \rightarrow$ Quantum Number

Normalization



$$\psi_n(x) = \underline{B} \sin\left(\frac{n\pi x}{l}\right) \quad E_n = \frac{h^2 n^2}{8ml^2} \quad n=1, 2, \dots$$

How to get B?

$$|\psi_n(x)|^2 dx = \psi_n^*(x) \psi_n(x) dx = \underline{\text{Probability}}$$

$$x \leq (\text{Particle position}) \leq x + dx$$

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \psi^*(x) \psi(x) dx = 1$$

$$\psi(x) = 0 \quad \text{if } x \leq 0 \text{ or } x > l$$

①

$$\Rightarrow 1 = \int_0^l [B \sin(n\pi x/l)]^* [B \sin(n\pi x/l)] dx$$

$$\Rightarrow 1 = B^2 \int_0^l \sin^2(n\pi x/l) dx$$

$$\Rightarrow \boxed{\int \sin^2(kx) = \frac{1}{2} (1 - \cos(2kx))} \quad \text{we know this}$$

$$\text{So, } 1 = \frac{B^2}{2} \int_0^l (1 - \cos(2n\pi x/l)) dx$$

$$\text{or, } \frac{2}{B^2} = \left(x - \frac{l}{2\pi n} \sin\left(\frac{2\pi n x}{l}\right) \right) \Big|_0^l$$

$$\text{or, } \frac{2}{B^2} = \left[l - \frac{l}{2\pi n} \sin(2\pi n) \right] - \left[0 - \frac{l}{2\pi} \sin(0) \right]$$

$$\text{or, } \frac{2}{B^2} = l \quad \text{or } B = \sqrt{\frac{2}{l}}$$

$$\boxed{\psi_n(x) = \sqrt{\frac{2}{l}} \sin\left(\frac{n\pi x}{l}\right)}$$

B $\rightarrow$ Normalization constant

wave function plot

$$\psi_n = \sqrt{\frac{2}{l}} \sin\left(\frac{n\pi x}{l}\right)$$

At Ground state, $n=1$

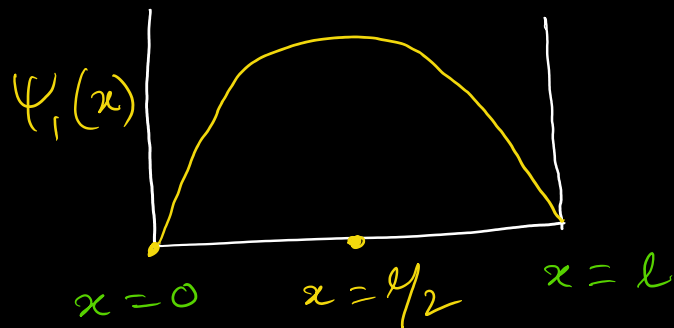
$$\psi_1 = \sqrt{\frac{2}{l}} \sin\left(\frac{\pi x}{l}\right)$$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \sin 0^\circ & \longrightarrow & \sin 90^\circ \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ 0 & \frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} & \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} & 1 \end{array}$$

For max. value of ψ_1

$$\sin\left(\frac{\pi x}{l}\right) = 1 = \sin\frac{\pi}{2}$$

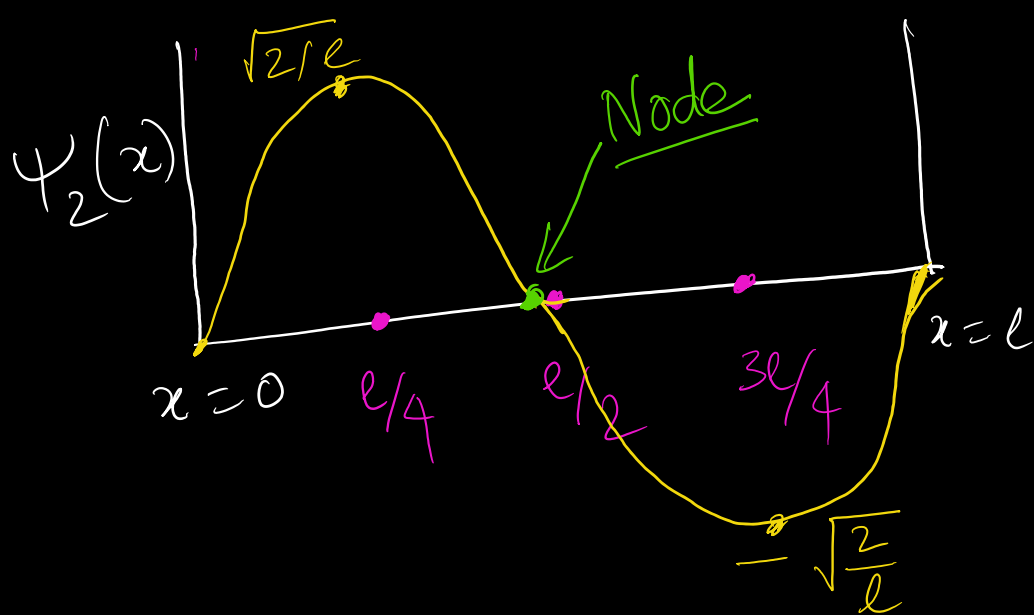
$$\text{So, } \frac{\pi x}{l} = \frac{\pi}{2} \quad , \text{ or, } \boxed{x = \frac{l}{2}}$$



First excited state, $n=2$ $\psi_2 = \sqrt{\frac{2}{l}} \sin\left(\frac{2\pi x}{l}\right)$, At what x , ψ_2 is max?

$$\sin\left(\frac{2\pi x}{l}\right) = 1 = \sin\frac{\pi}{2}$$

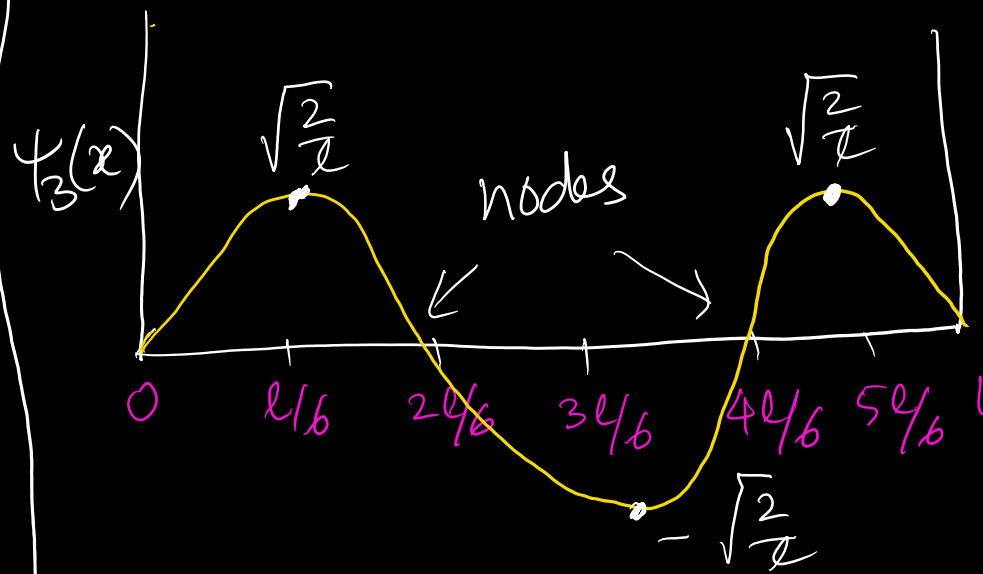
$$\Rightarrow \frac{2x}{l} = \frac{1}{2} \quad \text{or, } \boxed{x = \frac{l}{4}}$$



Second excited state: $n=3$

$$\boxed{x = l/6}$$

ES2 ——— $n=3$
ES1 ——— $n=2$
GS ——— $n=1$



Wave Function Plot 2

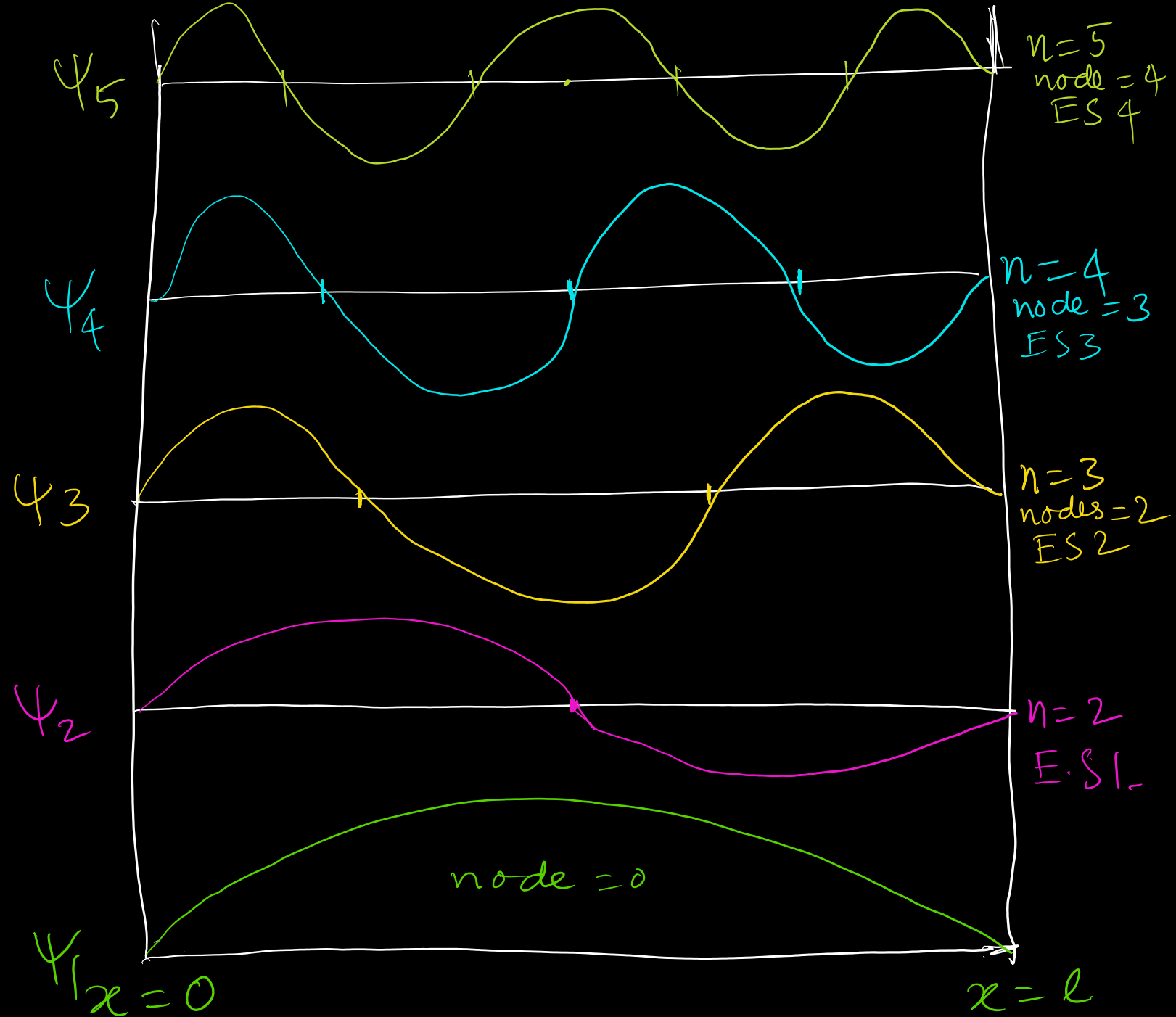
Plot of ψ_{10} ?

• at $x=0$
 $x=l$ } $\Rightarrow \psi = 0$

• Nodes = $(n-1)$

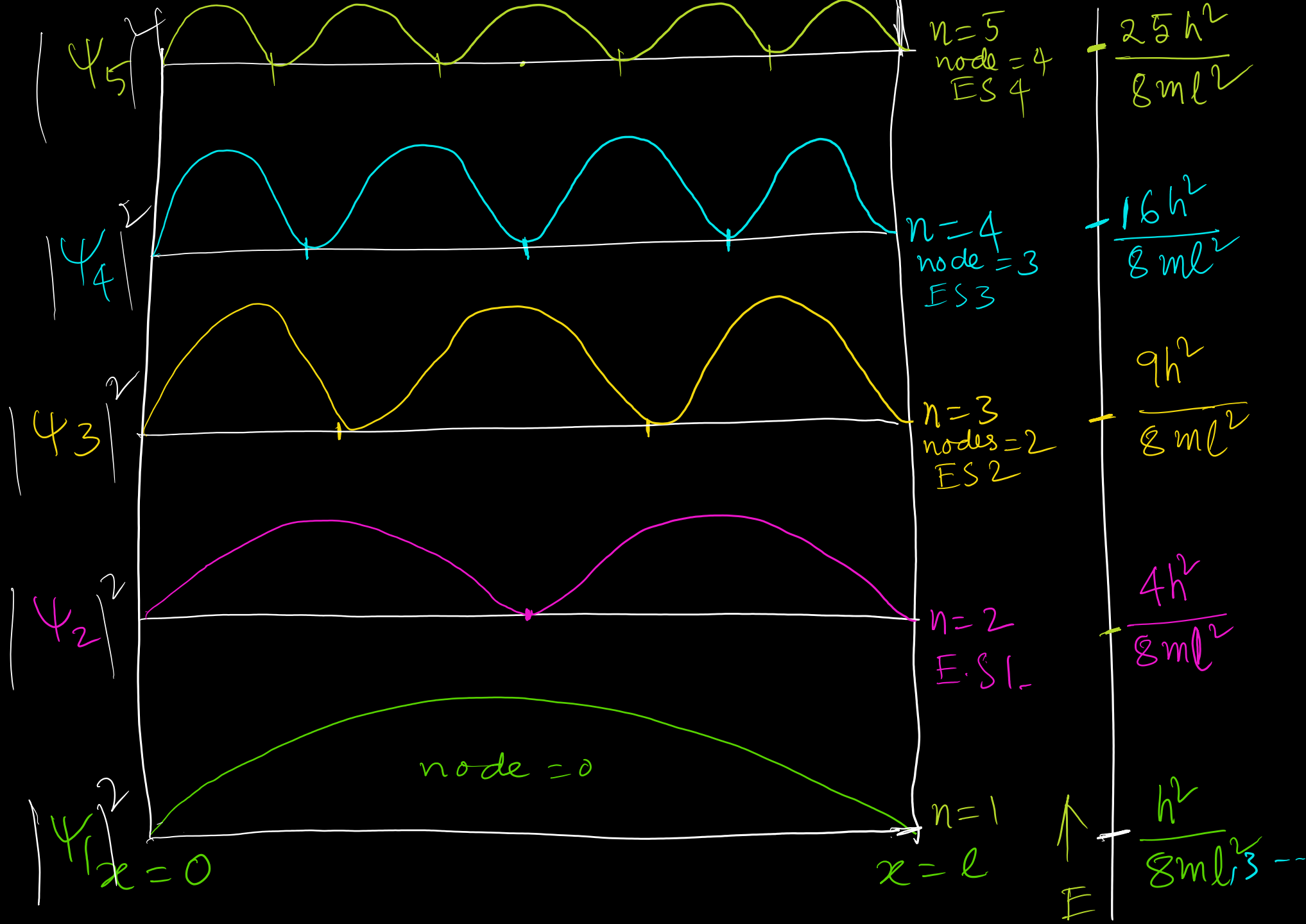
So for ψ_{10} , $n=10$
Nodes = $(n-1)$
 $= 10-1$
 $= 9$

• First curve will be increasing



Probability
of $\psi(x)$

$$\frac{h^2 n^2}{8ml^2}$$



Particle in 3D Box

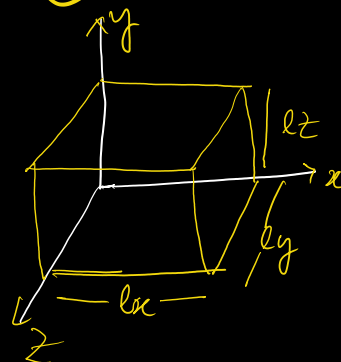
$$-\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \left(\frac{\partial^2 \psi}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\partial^2 \psi}{\partial y^2} + \frac{\partial^2 \psi}{\partial z^2} \right) = E \psi(x, y, z) \quad \text{--- (1)}$$

$$\nabla^2 = \frac{\partial^2}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\partial^2}{\partial y^2} + \frac{\partial^2}{\partial z^2}$$

$$-\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \nabla^2 \psi(x, y, z) = E \psi(x, y, z)$$

3D Schrodinger Equⁿ.

$$0 \leq i \leq l_i \quad i = x, y, z$$



$\psi(x, y, z)$ satisfies boundary condition $\Rightarrow$ vanishes at wall

$$\psi(0, y, z) = \psi(l_x, y, z) = 0 \text{ for all } y \text{ and } z$$

$$\psi(x, 0, z) = \psi(x, l_y, z) = 0 \text{ for all } x \text{ and } z$$

$$\psi(x, y, 0) = \psi(x, y, l_z) = 0 \text{ for all } x \text{ and } y$$

We will use method of separation of variables to solve eqⁿ (1)

$$\psi(x, y, z) = X(x) Y(y) Z(z) \quad \text{--- (2)}$$

Substituting eqⁿ (2) in (1) and then divide through by $\Rightarrow$

$$-\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{1}{X(x)} \frac{d^2 X}{dx^2} - \frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{1}{Y(y)} \frac{d^2 Y}{dy^2} - \frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{1}{Z(z)} \frac{d^2 Z}{dz^2} = E$$

$$E_x + E_y + E_z = E$$

$$-\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{d^2 X}{dx^2} = E_x X(x) \Rightarrow X_{n_x}(x) = A_x \sin\left(\frac{n_x \pi x}{l_x}\right)$$

$$-\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{d^2 Y}{dy^2} = E_y Y(y) \Rightarrow Y_{n_y}(y) = A_y \sin\left(\frac{n_y \pi y}{l_y}\right)$$

$$-\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{d^2 Z}{dz^2} = E_z Z(z) \Rightarrow Z_{n_z}(z) = A_z \sin\left(\frac{n_z \pi z}{l_z}\right)$$

$$\int_0^{l_x} dx \int_0^{l_y} dy \int_0^{l_z} dz \psi^*(x, y, z) \psi(x, y, z) = 1$$

$$A = A_x A_y A_z = \left(\sqrt{\frac{2}{l_x}}\right) \left(\sqrt{\frac{2}{l_y}}\right) \left(\sqrt{\frac{2}{l_z}}\right) = \sqrt{\frac{8}{l_x l_y l_z}}$$

$$\psi_{n_x n_y n_z}(x, y, z) = \sqrt{\frac{8}{l_x l_y l_z}} \sin\left(\frac{n_x \pi x}{l_x}\right) \sin\left(\frac{n_y \pi y}{l_y}\right) \sin\left(\frac{n_z \pi z}{l_z}\right)$$

$$E_{n_x n_y n_z} = \frac{\hbar^2}{8m} \left[\frac{n_x^2}{l_x^2} + \frac{n_y^2}{l_y^2} + \frac{n_z^2}{l_z^2} \right]$$

$$\left. \begin{matrix} n_x \\ n_y \\ n_z \end{matrix} \right\} 1, 2, 3, \dots$$

Zero point energy

→ Energy at G.S. $n=1$

$E \Rightarrow$ Additive
 $\Psi \Rightarrow$ Multiplicative

1D Box, $E_x = \frac{n^2 h^2}{8 m l_x^2}$, Zero point energy $(n=1) = \frac{1^2 h^2}{8 m l^2} = \frac{h^2}{8 m l^2}$

3D Box $E_T = E_x + E_y + E_z$
 $= \frac{n_x^2 h^2}{8 m l_x^2} + \frac{n_y^2 h^2}{8 m l_y^2} + \frac{n_z^2 h^2}{8 m l_z^2} = \frac{n_x^2 h^2}{8 m l^2} + \frac{n_y^2 h^2}{8 m l^2} + \frac{n_z^2 h^2}{8 m l^2}$

For cubic box $l_x = l_y = l_z = l$

$$E = \frac{h^2}{8 m l^2} (n_x^2 + n_y^2 + n_z^2)$$

→ 1 → 1 → 1

So, zero point energy = $3 \times \frac{h^2}{8 m l^2}$
(ZPE)

$$E_{\text{ZPE}}(3D) = 3 E_{\text{ZPE}}(1D)$$

$\underbrace{\hspace{10em}}_{h^2/8 m l^2}$

Degeneracy

States having equal energy

If $l_x = l_y = l_z = l \rightarrow$ Cube

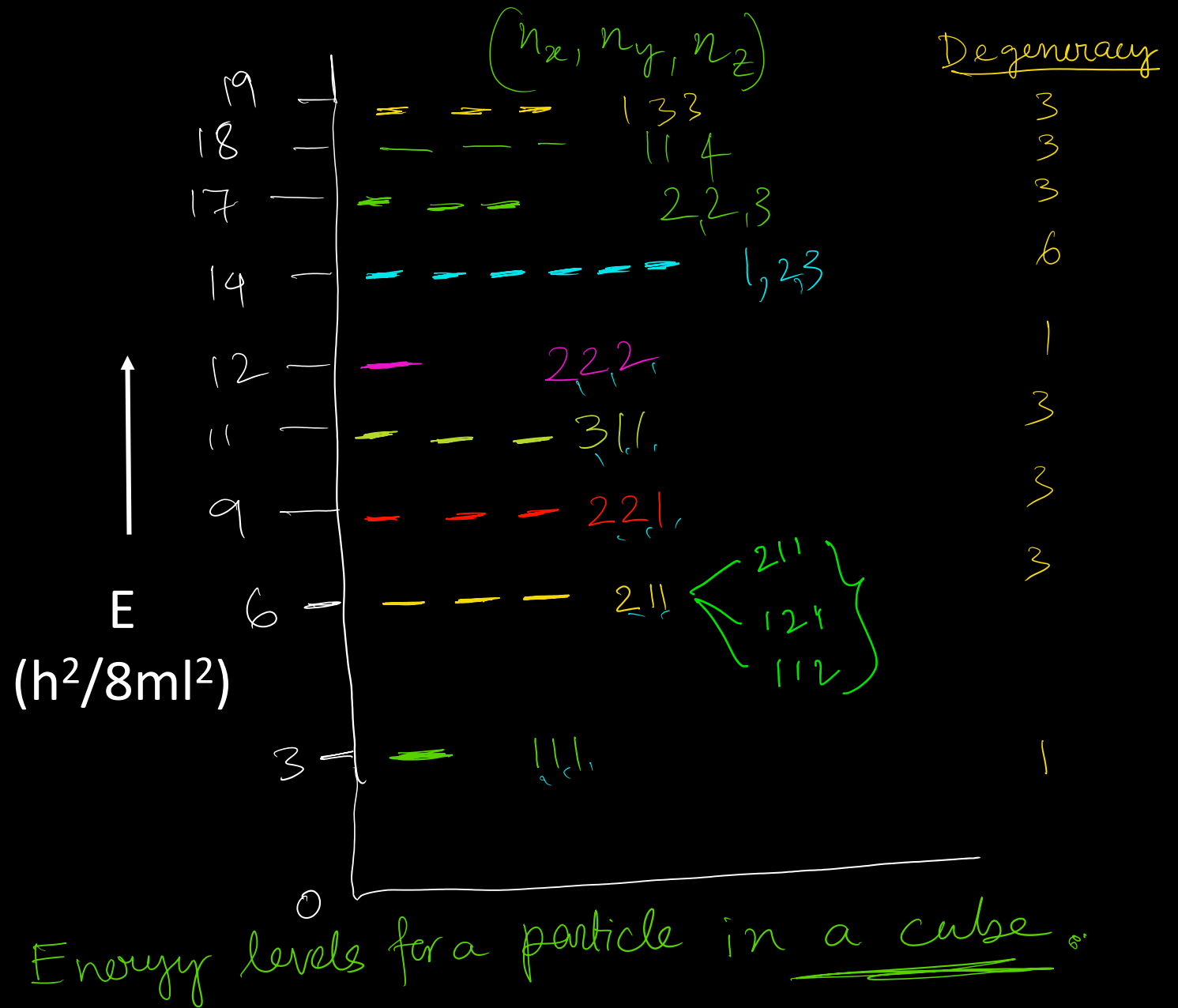
$$E_{n_x n_y n_z} = \frac{h^2}{8ml^2} (n_x^2 + n_y^2 + n_z^2)$$

Symmetry $\rightarrow$ Degeneracy

$$E_{111}$$

$$E_{112} / E_{211} / E_{121}$$

1 2 3
1 2 3
1 3 2
2 1 3
2 3 1
3 1 2
3 2 1



Problems

- Prove that average momentum of a particle in a box is zero.

$$\langle p \rangle = 0$$